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The Comfort Bond™



A FREE COMPANION FOR MOTHER'S DAY

The Mother's Day Connection Plan

A gentle 7-day path to a Mother's Day that feels real — whatever shape your mother is in this year.

For the daughter who doesn't know what to say anymore.

Less than 10 minutes a day.

thecomfortbond.com

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A letter — and how to use this plan

If you're here, you're probably holding something heavy.

Maybe your mother has dementia. Maybe she's in memory care. Maybe the last few visits have felt shorter than they used to, and you're not always sure she knows you came.

Mother's Day, when it looks like this, isn't the kind of Mother's Day the cards are written for.

This plan isn't going to make Mother's Day feel like it used to. That's not what we're after.

What we're after is one hour — this Mother's Day — that feels like a real moment between the two of you. Quiet. Warm. Without performance. Even if she doesn't say a word.

How to use this plan

Seven small practices, designed for the week leading up to Mother's Day — but yours to start whenever you need. Start today, or start seven days out.

Each day takes less than 10 minutes. Miss one and pick it back up. This is not an assignment. It's a companion.

By Mother's Day morning, you'll have a small object, a song, a letter, and a simple ritual — everything you need to walk into her room with something real in your hands and in your heart.

That's the whole plan.

— Francesca

Founder, The Comfort Bond™

QUICK START

If you only have 5 minutes

Some weeks don't go the way we plan them.

If Mother's Day is tomorrow and you've just opened this — or if you don't have a full seven days to prepare — this page is for you.

Here is the entire practice, in its simplest form:

1. **Bring one object.**
   Something small from your home that connects you to her. A photograph. A recipe card. A scarf.

2. **Play one song.**
   Her favorite, or one from her late teens or early 20s. Queue it on your phone.

3. **Sit beside her, not across from her.**
   Close enough to touch.

4. **Hold her hand.**
   That is the whole visit. If nothing else happens, this is enough.

Everything else in this plan is a deeper version of these four things. But on the hardest days, this is the whole practice.

1

DAY 1 · THIS DAY IS FOR YOU

Let yourself feel what you're feeling

Before you can be present with your mother, you have to make room for what you're carrying.

PRACTICE · 10 MINUTES

On a piece of paper, write three true sentences that begin: "This year, Mother's Day feels…"

Just make them true. Fold the paper. Put it somewhere you won't see it for a week.

Grief and love share the same room. You don't have to choose between them.

Why this matters

Naming the hard thing on paper, once, quietly loosens its grip. You'll walk into Sunday lighter.

2

DAY 2 · A SOFT REMINISCENCE

Remember her as she was

It's easy, in the season of her decline, to see her only as the mother who is fading. But she lived decades before you arrived — a whole woman, long before she was your mom.

PRACTICE · 10 MINUTES

Find one photograph of your mother from before you were born.

Sit with it. Write down three things you know about who she was then.

No photograph? Write them down anyway — stories she told you, anything you remember.

Why this matters

Remembering her full story changes the way you see her — and the way she may feel seen by you when you walk in.

3

DAY 3 · PACK THE VISIT

Pack a small object

Choose one small thing to bring with you on Mother's Day. Not a gift. A key — something that opens a door.

PRACTICE · 10 MINUTES

Find one small object in your home that connects the two of you:

A recipe card in her handwriting. A piece of fabric from a dress she wore. A pressed flower from a garden she kept. A scarf that still smells like her perfume. A postcard she sent you when you were twelve.

Set it aside. You'll bring it on Sunday.

Why this matters

Memory, in a fading mind, lives in the senses — not in words. A small, familiar object is a gentler door into connection than a conversation.

4

DAY 4 · MUSIC REACHES FIRST

Choose one song

Music reaches where words cannot.

PRACTICE · 5 MINUTES

Think of your mother's favorite song. If you don't know it, pick a song from her late teens or early 20s — the music a person typically imprints on for life.

Save it on your phone. Make sure you can play it on Sunday, quietly, without fumbling for it.

Why this matters

Familiar music is one of the most well-documented ways to reach someone with memory loss. You're not testing her. You're not asking "Do you remember this?" You're letting it play beside both of you. Music doesn't require her to perform recognition. It meets her where she is.

5

DAY 5 · LAY SOMETHING DOWN

Write her a letter

You don't have to read it to her. You don't have to give it to her. This is just for writing.

PRACTICE · 15 MINUTES

Write her a letter that begins:

"Mom, there's something I've always wanted to tell you…"

Finish it however feels true. It doesn't have to be beautiful.

Keep the letter somewhere safe. On Sunday, you'll decide — in the moment — whether to read part of it to her, leave it with her, or keep it for yourself. All three are right answers.

Why this matters

Some of what we carry for our parents doesn't need to be heard to be laid down. Just writing it changes how you arrive at her door.

6

DAY 6 · THE NIGHT BEFORE

Prepare the visit in your head

Mother's Day is tomorrow. Take ten quiet minutes today to walk through it.

PRACTICE · 10 MINUTES

Close your eyes. Walk through tomorrow: parking the car, the hallway, her door, sitting down beside her. What you'll do first.

Have your object ready (Day 3). Have your song saved (Day 4). Have your letter tucked in your bag (Day 5).

Decide one thing: what will you do in the first two minutes when you walk into her room?

Why this matters

The beginning of the visit is the part that carries the most anxiety. Deciding ahead of time — one small ritual to start with, like touching her hand, or putting on the song — removes the need to "figure it out" in the moment.

You've been preparing all week. Tomorrow, you just follow the plan.

BEFORE MOTHER'S DAY

If the moment feels quiet

Something I want you to know before you walk in tomorrow:

- **Silence is okay.**
  If she doesn't speak much — or at all — that is not a failed visit. Presence does not require conversation. Sitting beside her, holding her hand, letting the song play — that is connection. Full stop.

- **Repetition is okay.**
  If she says the same thing three times, answer it three times, the same way, gently. You are not correcting her. You are staying with her.

- **No response is still connection.**
  She may not recognize the object. She may not react to the song. She may look past you. None of this means she didn't feel you in the room. Your body beside hers, your hand on hers, your quiet voice — these reach her whether she responds or not.

- **It's okay if you cry.**
  You don't have to be composed. You don't have to protect her from your feelings. Sometimes the most real visits are the quiet ones where both people are just sitting with what is.

- **You are not failing her by not performing.**
  Our culture teaches us that visits should be cheerful, full of conversation, a kind of happy theater. But that is not what she needs from you on Mother's Day. She needs you there. That is all.

If the moment feels quiet — let it be quiet. That is the practice.

7

DAY 7 · MOTHER'S DAY · THE PRACTICE

The Presence Practice

Today is the day. Here's how to use everything you've prepared.

When you walk in

1. Sit beside her — not across from her.
2. Touch her hand, or her shoulder. A light, real touch.
3. Quietly start the song from Day 4. Low volume. No announcement.
4. Take out the object from Day 3. Hold it where she can see it. You don't have to explain it.
5. Narrate softly instead of asking questions. "I found this yesterday. It made me think of you." Let her respond, or not.
6. If words don't come, let them not come. The song is enough. Your hand is enough. Sit with her. Breathe with her.

When you leave

Before you walk out, hold her hand for a moment.

Say: "I'll see you again soon, Mom. I love you."

That's it. That's the whole ritual.

That is Mother's Day.

AFTER THE VISIT

When you get home tonight

Unfold the paper from Day 1. Read what you wrote.

Today wasn't the thing you were afraid of. You had tools. You had a plan. You showed up.

Some visits will still be hard. That won't change. But you have something now — a small, real way to be with her when the words don't come.

A song. An object. A letter. A hand. A ritual.

Carry them with you.

— Francesca
Founder, The Comfort Bond™

IF THIS HELPED

If you want more moments like this

If this plan helped you arrive at her door a little softer this week, we built something to help you keep doing it — for the visits after Mother's Day, and for every quiet Sunday after that.

PRIMARY · DIGITAL DOWNLOAD

The Mother's Day Connection Kit

$27 *Instant download · printable*

- 20 Conversation Cards — themed to your mother's life and decades.
- 15 Visual Spark Cards — for visits when words feel like too much.
- Decade-by-Decade Playlist Guide — songs that reach where words can't.
- "Letter to My Mother" printable template — for what you've always wanted to say.
- The Mother's Day Morning Ritual Guide — a calm 60-minute walkthrough for the day itself.

Get it at thecomfortbond.com/kits

FOR THE LONG ROAD

The 90-Day Meaningful Visit System

A three-month guided framework for ongoing connection — weekly themes, gentle rituals, and quiet structure for the days you don't know where to begin.

Tools for meaningful connection when memory is fading.

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